quantum physics only deepened the problem for the Copenhagen interpretation. For any entangled system, Einstein's choice applied: either the system is nonlocal, or quantum physics can't fully describe all the features of that system. And Schrödinger had just shown that nearly any quantum interaction would result in an entangled system. Thus, the challenge the EPR paper posed wasn't limited to some tiny corner of quantum physics—it was deeply embedded in the fundamental structure of the theory.

But Einstein's fears that the forced choice between nonlocality and incompleteness had been smothered in the EPR paper were sadly justified. In a letter to Einstein, Schrödinger vented his frustration over how badly other physicists had missed the point: "It is as if one person said, 'It is bitter cold in Chicago'; and another answered, 'That is a fallacy, it is very hot in Florida.'" Einstein himself received many letters from other physicists vigorously defending the Copenhagen interpretation and pointing out where the EPR paper had gone wrong—but he was amused to find that the letters all disagreed about where exactly that was! Many were under the impression that the EPR argument, and all of Einstein's problems with quantum theory, were based on a desire for a clockwork deterministic universe, like the universe of Newton's physics. They might have been misled by Einstein's famous exclamation about a dice-playing God. But Einstein's concerns had little, if anything, to do with determinism—they were about the importance of locality and a physical reality that exists independently of anyone observing it. Quantum physics, said Einstein, "avoids reality and reason." In his view, physics had been led astray by following Bohr. Writing to Schrödinger, Einstein described Bohr as a "talmudic philosopher [who] doesn't give a hoot for 'reality,' which he regards as a hobgoblin of the naive."

Yet, in the eyes of most contemporary physicists, Einstein's concerns were irrelevant at best and misguided at worst. The English physicist Charles Darwin (named after his famous grandfather) said, "It is a part of my doctrine that the details of a physicist's philosophy do not matter much." Darwin had once been Bohr's student, like many of the physicists at the forefront of quantum physics research—and almost none had ever worked with Einstein. Thus, in the clash between the two on matters of quantum philosophy, most physicists were inclined to follow "Bohr's